

The Sentinel System: An Assistant for the Overloaded Clinician

An Assistant for the Overloaded Clinician

Word count: 247

Clinicians are overburdened. Their patients spend 167 of every 168 hours out of sight - risk builds unseen and surfaces only at the next appointment. Meanwhile, documentation, journal review, and manual risk assessment consume the hours clinicians should spend with patients. With caseloads far beyond safe limits, burnout and secondary trauma are baked into the job. Patients carry this cost directly: when no one sees the between-session hours, risk is discovered late and crises land without warning.

Sentinel gives the clinician a tireless assistant. It reads every journal, classifies emotion across 28 labels, and synthesizes clinical notes in OAP format - returning hours of documentation time. A risk-prioritized triage queue surfaces the sickest patients first, and crisis cases auto-expand. When a crisis triggers, a staged protocol responds automatically - an immediate siren, a trusted-contact email with a signed link at 30 seconds, and helpline escalation at 60 seconds - and the clinician halts it with one tap, freezing the timer and never being the single point of failure.

The platform also watches over the clinician: self-monitoring metrics surface their own stress and fatigue before secondary trauma sets in. Privacy is absolute - the AI runs locally, so data never leaves the clinic.

Sentinel does not replace clinical judgment. It protects it - and gives it back the time it lost. Already built and validated, with 98/98 tests passing at a \$0 monthly operating cost. It is not another dashboard; it is hours returned.